NORTHSTAR COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS

SG-001 - Product Recommendation & Solution-Fit Playbook

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Purpose

Guides evaluation and recommendation of products or solution configurations. It helps move from 'Which products could work?' to 'Which technically valid option best aligns with the customer's stated requirements and priorities?' It never overrides technical documentation, bulletins, compatibility evidence, commercial policy, customer agreements, or structured business data.

Core Recommendation Principle

A recommendation may optimize among technically valid options; it must never make an invalid option valid. First establish validity against mandatory requirements and authoritative constraints. Then evaluate fit among the remaining valid options.

Mandatory Requirements vs Preferences

Mandatory requirements include required utilities, minimum capacity, physical constraints, required function, mandatory compatibility, and applicable installation requirements. Preferences may include lower acquisition cost, smaller footprint, energy efficiency, additional capacity, future expansion, operational headroom, or reuse of existing equipment.

Recommendation Sequence

Understand the requirement; identify candidate products; eliminate invalid options; identify unresolved dependencies; compare valid options; recommend with rationale. When several options remain reasonable, present the trade-off rather than inventing a technical winner.

Minimum Fit vs Recommended Fit

Minimum fit means the product satisfies known mandatory requirements. Recommended fit means it also aligns better with operating conditions, priorities, or reasonable headroom. Do not describe a minimum-fit option as technically inadequate merely because another option is stronger operationally.

Operational Headroom

Headroom is spare capability above expected operating requirement. It can matter under high utilization, peaks, uptime priorities, or reasonable growth. It is advisory, not a universal fixed percentage. More capacity is not automatically better.

UrbanFork Example

Both Frostline UC-220 and UC-240E can satisfy the core refrigeration requirement. UC-220 favors lower acquisition cost; UC-240E favors smaller footprint, energy efficiency, and slightly greater capacity. If footprint and efficiency remain priorities, UC-240E is the stronger recommended fit, while UC-220 remains a valid alternative.

Nusantara Catering Example

CT-80 may meet the minimum known requirement. CT-110 provides additional working capacity and headroom that better aligns with confirmed high utilization and uptime priorities. Do not call CT-80 inadequate unless authoritative evidence establishes that.

Existing Equipment and Reuse

Confirm what the customer owns, authoritative purchase or installed history, lifecycle status, documented compatibility, required accessories, and unresolved conditions. Historical ownership does not prove compatibility, and technical possibility does not prove ownership of a required accessory.

Lifecycle, Inventory, and Commercial Context

ACTIVE products normally support new recommendations when appropriate. PHASE_OUT and DISCONTINUED products remain relevant for installed-base and historical reasoning. Available stock does not establish technical fit; incoming inventory does not guarantee arrival; stock does not establish installation capacity. Commercial attractiveness never overrides technical validity.

Missing Information

When a material requirement is unknown, limit the recommendation. State what is unknown, why it matters, and what information would resolve it rather than converting the gap into an assumption.

Recommendation Strength

Use strong recommendation when mandatory requirements are established and one valid option clearly aligns better with documented priorities; conditional recommendation when a material condition remains unresolved; multiple-valid-options framing when the deciding preference is unknown; and no reliable recommendation when required evidence is insufficient.

Boundaries

SALES_ADVISORY guidance may compare valid options, surface trade-offs, identify gaps, and explain minimum versus recommended fit. It cannot override incompatibility, invent specifications, establish ownership or inventory, authorize discounts, override agreements, guarantee arrival or installation, or resolve authoritative conflicts through sales preference.

Reasoning Pattern

REQUIREMENT -> VALID OPTIONS -> CONSTRAINTS -> TRADE-OFFS -> RECOMMENDATION -> CONDITIONS.